



**Dallas Center-Grimes
Community School District**
High School

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March 2026

DCGCSD School Board Report

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March Welcome | Principal Matthew Blackmore

Dallas Center-Grimes High School

Welcome to March, Mustangs! This month is packed with opportunities to celebrate our DCG diversity, showcase our school spirit, and prepare for our final academic push as we head into the home stretch of the school year.

- The "Fresh Start" Effect: Even though Term 3 ends at the end of March, the change in weather acts as a "second New Year." Students are encouraged to continue to challenge their minds academically as we near our "Spring Break" and final term next month!
- Testing Resilience: While "state testing (ISASP)" is on the horizon, the optimism comes from preparedness. There is a quiet confidence in seeing teachers and students tackle the final reviews with a "we've got this" attitude. Practice testing and test resilience will prepare students in March for April success!
- Building the Future: March is when we begin "Master Scheduling" for the following year. While it's a logistical puzzle, it's inherently optimistic—it's the act of designing the next chapter of success before the current one has even finished!



Key Dates at a Glance

Date	Event
March 2 – 6	Inclusive Schools Week
March 3	Girls State Basketball Tournament
March 7	"Take Two" Show Choir Invitational
March 13 – 22	Spring Break (No School)
March 27	End of Term 3
March 30	No School (Teacher Work Day)
March 31	Start of Term 4



Inclusive Schools Week (March 2 – 6)

DCG is proud to participate in Inclusive Schools Week. This week is dedicated to promoting awareness and taking action around diversity, equity, and inclusion. It is a time for our students and educators to honor the strides we've made in breaking down barriers—whether they are related to disabilities, cultural backgrounds, language, gender identity, or socioeconomic status.

- Expect to see classroom discussions and activities focused on fostering an environment where every single Mustang can thrive.

Postseason Fever: Girls State Basketball

Good luck to our Girls Mustang Basketball team as they take the court for the State Tournament on Tuesday, March 3! We are incredibly proud of your hard work and determination this season. Let's bring that DCG energy to the stands and cheer them on to victory at the Casey's Center!

Show Choir Hosts "Take Two"

On Saturday, March 7, DCG High School will be buzzing with talent as we host our annual "Take Two" Show Choir Invitational. It's a full day of incredible performances from across the area. Be sure to come out and support our performers and the many volunteers who make this massive event possible.

Academic Updates

ISASP Practice Testing

This month, students will begin preparing for the Iowa Statewide Assessment of Student Progress (ISASP).

- What is it? The mandatory annual summative test for grades 3–11.
- What is tested? Proficiency in English Language Arts, Mathematics, and Science (Science is for grade 10 only).
- Why? These assessments are aligned with the Iowa Core standards to ensure our students are meeting vital academic benchmarks.

End of Term 3

The finish line for Term 3 is Friday, March 27. Students are encouraged to check their portals and connect with teachers regarding any outstanding assignments before the term closes.

Spring Break & Schedule Shifts

Enjoy your well-deserved break! There will be no school from Friday, March 13 through Sunday, March 22.

Additionally, please note that there is no school on Monday, March 30 due to a Teacher Work Day. We will welcome everyone back to kick off Term 4 on Tuesday, March 31.